[METRIC]
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SUPERCEDES
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May 6, 1981

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TOWEL, PAPER (INDUSTRIAL WIPING)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE. This commercial item description (CID) covers nonwoven industrial strength paper towels.

2. CLASSIFICATION. The towels shall be the following types:

Type I - Light Duty
Type II - Medium Duty
Type III - Heavy Duty
Type IV - Heavy Duty, Reinforced
Type V - Heavy Duty, Reinforced, Decomposable

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

3.1 Material, types I, II, & III. The types I, II & III towels shall be of single or multi-ply construction meeting the requirements of Table I. The towels shall have creped or embossed surfaces to facilitate wiping utility.

3.2 Material, type IV. The type IV towel shall meet the requirements of table I and shall be of a 2 ply (minimum) construction with a mesh reinforcement between the plies.

3.3 Material, type V. The type V towel shall meet the requirements of table I and shall be of 3 ply (minimum) construction with a mesh reinforcement. The mesh shall be constructed in such a manner that it is not woven and is not bonded to itself prior to lamination so that when the laminated paper is removed it shall not form a cohesive net. The entire assembly shall decompose when tested as specified in 3.3.1.

Table I, Physical characteristics

Characteristic	Type I	Type II	Type III	Type IV & V	TAPPI Test Method
Grammage (g/m^2, minimum)	17.9	27.6	68.3	65.0	T410
Tensile strength,					
Dry (N/m, minimum)	.042	.085	.155	.247	T494
Wet (N/m, minimum)	.010	.021	.049	.176	T456
Absorption rate (sec., max.)					
water -	10	10	10	8	T432
oil -	20	20	20	-	T432\1
Total Absorption,					
% of dry weight (minimum)					
Water -	275	300	450	500	Para. 3.4.1
Oil -	150	150	275	200	Para. 3.4.2

\1 Use light mineral oil, viscosity 80-90 SU (Saybolt Universal) instead of water.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: General Services Administration, Engineering Group (7FXEE), 819 Taylor Street, Fort Worth, TX 76102

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FSC 7920

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3.3.1 Decomposition test. Specimens approximately 21.5 by 28 cm shall be cut from the samples to be tested. In separate 9 inch x 11 inch, 1-1/2" deep disposable aluminum pans, each sample shall be buried in commercial potting soil with 1% by weight organic plant fertilizer (3-5-1) and 1% by weight bacteria (Hy-yield stump removal compound), the mixture shall be thoroughly mixed together just prior to burying the sample. The mixture shall be enough to form a 1-1/4 inch deep layer of mixture in each pan. The specimens shall be irregularly buried so that some edges show above the mixture and some areas are covered by as much as 1 inch of mixture. No water is to be added to the mixture. Upon burying the specimens, each pan shall be sealed in polyethylene bags and stored in the dark at room temperature (20°C to 23°C) for ten days. After this time has passed, the bags shall be opened and the specimens examined. The specimens shall have no evidence of perceptible strength of either the paper or the mesh that has been buried. Any perceptible or measurable strength of the any of the buried paper or mesh specimens shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

3.4 Absorbency. The type I cloths shall have the absorbency capacity required by table I. The test for this shall be as follows:

3.4.1 Water. Cut specimens (10 cm x 10 cm is recommended) and weight to nearest 0.1 g. Entirely immerse each sample in distilled water at 25°C for 3 minutes without movement. Remove by lifting at one corner until entire specimen is clear of the water, allow excess water to drain off for 60 seconds. Place each in a tared weighing bottle and reweigh. Calculate the percent absorption to the nearest 1 percent as follows:

Percent absorption =
((Wet weight - dry weight)/ dry weight] x 100

3.4.2 Oil. Same as 3.3.1 using white mineral oil, viscosity 80-90 SU (Saybolt Universal), in lieu of water. Drain time shall be 20 minutes.

3.5 Size. Unless otherwise specified, the individual towels shall be one of the following sizes, the dimensions specified are those of the minimum side length and the minimum overall area:

Size 1 - 11 cm min. x 238 cm^2 min.
Size 2 - 20 cm min. x 774 in cm^2 min.
Size 3 - 29 cm min. x 1109 cm^2 min.
Size 4 - 29 cm min. x 1258 cm^2 min.
Size 5 - 30 cm min. x 1129 cm^2 min.
Size 6 - 30 cm min. x 1451 cm^2 min.
Size 7 - 32 cm min. x 1193 cm^2 min.
Size 8 - 32 cm min. x 1516 cm^2 min.
Size 9 - 36 cm min. x 1580 cm^2 min.

3.6 Unitization/packaging. The towels shall be unitized and packaged as specified by the contract or purchase order. For the lowest level of required packaging, the average package count of 10 packages randomly chosen from the lot shall be plus or minus 2 the required number of towels at that package level, no package shall contain 5 below the required number of towels.

3.7 Workmanship. The towels shall be free from holes, tears, dirt, spots, ragged or uneven edges, or any other defects that affect serviceability.

3.8 Commercial item. The use of the term "commercial item description" in this document does not imply that any item or items offered are not required to conform with all requirements specified herein.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

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5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

5.1 General quality statement. The products provided shall conform to the requirements of this commercial item description, and the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

6. PACKAGING, PACKING AND MARKING. The packaging, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. NOTES

7.1 Intended use. Towels described by this CID are intended for general cleaning, polishing and wiping, on dry, wet, and oily surfaces.

7.2 Ordering data. Purchases should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

a. Title, number, and date of this CID.
b. Type and size.
c. The packaging, packing and marking desired

7.3 Part Identification Number (PIN). This part numbering system is intended for identification and cross-indexing of the item by the government only and does not constitute a requirement for the contractor.

Example: AA1432-A 1

CID A-A-1432

A = Type I	1 = Size 1
B = Type II	2 = Size 2
C = Type III	3 = Size 3
D = Type IV	4 = Size 4
E = Type V	5 = Size 5
	6 = Size 6
	7 = Size 7
	8 = Size 8
	9 = Size 9

7.4 National Stock Numbers. The following NSNs (with the appropriate part number) are known to use this document:

NSN	PN
7920-00-543-6492	AA1432-A9
7920-00-682-6710	AA1432-A2
7920-00-721-8884	AA1432-A1
7920-00-823-6931	AA1432-C3
7920-00-823-9772	AA1432-D8
7920-00-823-9773	AA1432-D7
7920-00-982-1203	AA1432-B4
7920-01-370-1364	AA1432-E5
7920-01-370-1365	AA1432-E6

7.5 Referenced documents.

TAPPI

T410 Grammage of Paper and Paperboard (Weight Per Unit Area)

T432 Water Absorbency of Bibulous Paper

T456 Wet Tensile Breaking Strength of Paper and Paperboard

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T494 Tensile Breaking Properties of Paper and Paperboard (Using Constant Rate of Elongation Apparatus)

TAPPI documents are available from TAPPI, 15 Technology Parkway South, Norcross, GA 30092, (404) 446-1400.

Preparing Activity:
GSA - FSS

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